

Wi-Fi in the sky

Some US based domestic airlines are offering the service at 30,000 feet

daily stations from around the world. Virgin radio (now called *Absolute Radio*) is also an excellent option. For gamers, there is always N-Gage gaming or the option of downloading Java games from the thousands of web sites available. iPhone users have their own set of games that can be downloaded. Check out our Fast Track on Mobile Apps bundled with this issue for more.

Hosting a server at home has other advantages as well. Using your cell phone, you can log into the web interface for Utorrent and start a download; by the time you reach home, you have data ready for your consumption. This server can also serve up files from your hard drive, so in effect, you're carrying your entire hard drive wherever you go. Once you have the file with you on the phone's memory, you are free to do whatever you want with it. Check out the *Do This* box for more info.

For viewing office documents, there are many free apps that you can download for Symbian. Many of these come pre-installed for S60 and Windows Mobile. As for editing office documents there is Open Office for Sony Ericsson Symbian UIQ.

For viewing PDFs, there is Adobe Reader that is bundled with most Nokia N-series phones. Foxit Reader is supported on Symbian UIQ again and available free on Windows Mobile.

Geographical connect

GPS is also getting increasingly popular in India. The geographic location service offered by GPS and A-GPS providers are so sophisticated that if you if you have a compatible phone, it even shows which side of the road you are on, besides giving you turn by turn directions for most points of interest (POI) such as restaurants, ATMs, malls and various other businesses. Most N-series Nokia phones come with a built-in GPS unit and mapping software, but the mapping software expires after a certain trial period. Even after it expires, the maps are available but turn-by-turn directions support switches off. If you have a Windows Mobile phone which doesn't have in-built GPS, you can get a unit separately that will pair with the phone via Bluetooth. Then all you need is to find

a solution for mapping software.

In the case of Nokia phones, you need to purchase mapping support from Nokia after the trial version expires. But there are other applications and providers in the market with both paid and free solutions. A trial software for Symbian is available from SatGuide that works on most N- and E-series Nokia phones. The trial version with limited usage comes with maps and POIs for 26 cities. A full version can be purchased for Rs. 2,000 (one time), it offers more detail and maps of over 200 cities across India. Another alternative is to use Google Maps. Download the Google Maps application from m.google.com/maps and you will get driving and transit directions, which are not very good, but acceptable. The application is built for almost all mobile OS platforms. The application will also give you access to phone numbers and addresses for local businesses. Google Maps triangulates your location based on your nearest cell site signal or even via GPS if your phone has it. Users say it's faster than using pure GPS.

So there you have it. A multitude of ways to connect, share and do more with your phone. So go ahead, join the culture of connectivity and remain always on! 



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